

Literature dissection

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Photo documentation

Table

Photo point number	Date of photo	Season	Direction of photo	Link to photo
14_W_Oct24	October 24, 2024	Fall	West	click here
14_W_April2025	April 14, 2025	Spring	West	click here
14_NE_Oct24	October 14, 2024	Fall	North East	click here
14_NE_April2025	April 14, 2025	Spring	North East	click here

8. Describe in 5-7 sentences total:

We chose to examine the 2025 water year. This water year is relevant to our study because the dataset that we are examining (veg) covers years from 2021-2025, so we are looking at recent photos to see what the grassland habitat has transformed into and how that compares to our data. We are also looking at how our visualizations might vary over season (October vs. April). We chose to examine two photo points at spot 22. The first pictures point west and the second set points northeast facing the slough. This photo point is relevant to our study because we want to examine grasslands at a time when a major prescribed fire occurred, as well as a wet water year. We see significant changes in vegetation abundance in April compared to October for both directions. There is higher abundance in April as well as it being greener. This could point to higher numbers of both native and non-native species presence. The northeast photos also show changes in water elevation for the slough, as it is higher in April than in October.

Reports or posters

Report or poster information

Title: **Evaluating Sheep Grazing as a Strategy for Restoring the North Campus Open Space (NCOS) Grasslands**

Authors: Abby Nestor, Dr. Lisa Stratton, Dr. Carla D'Antonio

Year published: 2025

Permalink: [click here](#)

Data set used (likely): sampling biomass of native and non-native species of interest, original to the study

Key insights: This poster wanted to document the effects of sheep grazing as a restoration technique at the NCOS Grasslands. They picked two natives and three non-native species and weighed biomass samples of each species before and after the grazing event. They also observed growth of different plant species from sheep pellets to determine which species would have

been consumed most. What they found from their pellet analysis was that grazing decreased biomass of *Medicago polymorpha* overwhelmingly more than any other species, as the sheep preferred nitrogen fixing legumes. The presence of sheep in the open space over time also encouraged native plant growth, as the grasses would flatten to make way for more plants.

Relevance to your study: This poster is relevant to our study because we are considering looking at the different restoration techniques of the open space's grassland, and sheep grazing has been a prominent strategy in recent years. Different events, whether natural or anthropogenic, can influence the growth of different species because they do not respond to these events similarly, nor do the events favor the species equally (e.g., humans dig out invasive species only, sheep prefer to eat nitrogen fixing legumes). Sheep grazing is just one technique that we are interested in considering while we analyze our vegetation data, to see if there are more variables affecting native plant growth than just competition with non-native species.

Annotated bibliography

Background

You can find peer-reviewed articles by searching on Google Scholar, which is a large database of research papers, posters, and other materials.

Note: while it may be tempting to use AI to provide a list of papers for you, you should *not* be using AI for any component of this activity. You'll accomplish the objective of articulating the connection between your study and other study systems/questions by completing the difficult task of sifting through papers that may not be relevant to you before finding one that is.

Additionally, you can test out inserting citations in Quarto. See [this resource to insert a citation in a .qmd](#).

Directions

Individually:

1. Search Google Scholar for papers that might be relevant to your study. One recommendation for how to start: search for whatever your focal variables may be + "wetland restoration" (for example, "bird abundance wetland restoration", "water salinity wetland restoration", "aquatic invertebrate wetland restoration").
2. Find 4-5 papers that might be relevant based on title and what shows up in the search.
3. Read the abstracts of those 4-5 papers.

4. Decide which - if any - are actually relevant to your project. Make a note of these papers. Note that a paper may be relevant in that it shares a) taxonomic groups, b) geographic regions, c) research questions, d) research methodology - there are lots of ways that existing research can be tied into your project.
5. If step 4 did not yield any relevant papers, repeat steps 2-4.
6. Search for papers until you have 4 relevant papers per person (12 total for a 3 person group).

As a group:

7. Share the papers you found, discussing the main points of the paper and how they are relevant to your project.
8. Fill in the template for an annotated bibliography below.
9. In the “Main findings” or “Relevance to study” sections, insert a citation for the paper.

Paper 1

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 2

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 3

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 4

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 5

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 6

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 7

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 8

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 9

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 10

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 12

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

References